Gmail

Tom Piccolo <tompiccolo50@gmail.com>

RE: Had a question for the Department of Optometry

5 messages

OPTOMAdmissions <OPTOMAdmissions@cardiff.ac.uk>
To: "tompiccolo50@gmail.com" <tompiccolo50@gmail.com>

20 February 2024 at 15:14

Hello Tom

Thank you for your enquiry.

The entry criteria are set based on a wide range of factors, which may include, but are not limited to, ensuring that University quality and academic standards are upheld, the previous year's entry criteria, the total number of applicants and the number expected to meet the criteria.

The entry criteria for each year are signed off and agreed by the University's Admissions and Recruitment Group in the previous Admissions cycle.

Regards

Judith

Judith Colwill

Administration Officer

Cardiff University

School of Optometry & Vision Sciences

Maindy Road

Cathays

Cardiff

CF24 4HQ

Hours of Work:

Monday-Thursday 08:30-16:30

Judith Colwill

Swyddog Gweinyddol

Yr Ysgol Optometreg & Gwyddorau'r Golwg

Heol Maindy

Cathays

Caerdydd

CF24 4HQ

Oriau Gwaith:

Dydd Llun-Ddydd Lau 08:30-16 :30

From: Admissions@cardiff.ac.uk <Admissions@cardiff.ac.uk>
Sent: Tuesday, February 20, 2024 2:20 PM
To: OPTOMAdmissions <OPTOMAdmissions@cardiff.ac.uk>
Subject: FW: Had a question for the Department of Optometry

Please respond to the enquirer directly. You can find the enquirer's email address below.

Dear colleague,

Please see the enquiry we have received below. Would you be able to provide the enquirer with the requested information? We would appreciate if this could be actioned within 5 working days.

Kind regards / Cofion cynnes,

Enquiry Team

Joseph Prosser

Enquiries Team

Cardiff University

Joseph Prosser

Tîm Ymholiadau

Prifysgol Caerdydd

From: Cardiff University Bot
To: Tom Piccolo <tompiccolo50@gmail.com>
At: Mon Feb 19 2024 19:10:08 GMT+0000 (Coordinated Universal Time)

Hello

Thank you for your enquiry.

We are experiencing a high volume of enquiries and expect to respond to you within 10 working days. Please avoid sending duplicate enquiries as this will cause a delay in our response to you. If your enquiry is urgent and requires an immediate response, please call us on +44 (0) 2920 879999 (lines are open Monday to Friday, 08.30-17.00 (UK time)).

If you are a student and/or if your enquiry is related to enrolment, CAS/Visa or remote study options, please contact Student Connect for assistance with your enquiry. You can contact them in the following ways:

- Use your Student Connect portal, if you are a current student
- Email - studentconnect@cardiff.ac.uk
- Phone +44(0)29 2251 8888

Kind regards

Cardiff University Admissions Team

Helo

Diolch am eich ymholiad.

Rydym yn derbyn nifer fawr o ymholiadau ac yn disgwyl ymateb i chi o fewn 5 diwrnod gwaith. Dylech osgoi anfon mwy nag un ymholiad gan y bydd hyn yn achosi oedi yn ein hymateb i chi. Os oes angen ymateb mwy brys arnoch i'ch ymholiad, ffoniwch ni ar +44 (0) 2920 879999 (mae'r llinellau ar agor o ddydd Llun i ddydd Gwener, 08.30-17.00 (amser y DU)).

Os ydych yn fyfyriwr a/neu os yw eich ymholiad yn gysylltiedig â chofrestriad, CAS/Fisa neu opsiynau astudio o bell, cysylltwch â Chyswllt Myfyrwyr am gymorth gyda'ch ymholiad. Gallwch gysylltu â nhw yn y ffyrdd canlynol, ond nodwch bydd y dyddiadau cau yn effeithio ar y gwasanaeth hwn hefyd:

- Defnyddiwch eich porth Cyswllt Myfyrwyr, os ydych yn fyfyriwr ar hyn o bryd
- Ebost: studentconnect@caerdydd.ac.uk
- Ffôn: +44(0)29 2251 8888

Cofion Cynnes

Tîm Derbyn Prifysgol Caerdydd

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From: Tom Piccolo <tompiccolo50@gmail.com>
To: Cardiff University Admissions <Admissions@cardiff.ac.uk>
At: Mon Feb 19 2024 19:10:06 GMT+0000 (Coordinated Universal Time)

Hello

I hope you are well, and many thanks for your email helping me with my previous enquiry.

Could you please forward the below email onto your Optometry department who can then get back to me- I had a question for them:

Hello

I hope you are well

I had a question regarding the a level entry requirements for Optometry. They all seem to be consistent; asking for A grades in two sciences and grades from AAA-AAB.

Does this mirror the high academic difficulty of Optometry degree courses? If Optometry courses were to lower entry requirements to CCC or BCC, would this potentially detriment the profession as now students of a lower academic calibre are being admitted?

I have heard from an optometry lecturer in a course with AAA requirements who said "students who do get in with B and C grades really struggle [with the academic content of this course]"

Also the College, online, has made a statement on apprenticeships saying that the entry requirements should ensure that "students who are admitted have the potential to achieve the academic requirement of an optometry degree".

Surely the high entry requirements, like fields such as medicine and dentistry, do mirror exactly the depth of the academic content involved. In that, there is a reason why, aside from competition for places, the entry requirements are quite high.

Many thanks

Many thanks

Tom Piccolo

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Tom Piccolo <tompiccolo50@gmail.com>
To: OPTOMAdmissions <OPTOMAdmissions@cardiff.ac.uk>

21 February 2024 at 00:51

Hello

Have the entry criteria got anything to do with the academic difficulty of the respective course, as I have been told by various other universities such as Hertfordshire and Aston?

Many thanks

Tom Piccolo

[Quoted text hidden]

OPTOMAdmissions <OPTOMAdmissions@cardiff.ac.uk>
To: "tompiccolo50@gmail.com" <tompiccolo50@gmail.com>

22 February 2024 at 16:36

Hello Tom

Please see below the answer to your question.

Yes, this is one consideration included within our aim to ensure academic quality and standards, however the decision making is never based on just the one aspect, since all factors need to be considered.

Regards

Judith

Judith Colwill

Administration Officer

Cardiff University

School of Optometry & Vision Sciences

Maindy Road

Cathays

Cardiff

CF24 4HQ

Tel: (0)29 208 74374

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CF24 4HQ

Oriau Gwaith:

Dydd Llun-Ddydd Lau 08:30-16 :30

From: Tom Piccolo <tompiccolo50@gmail.com>
Sent: Wednesday, February 21, 2024 12:51 AM
To: OPTOMAdmissions <OPTOMAdmissions@cardiff.ac.uk>
Subject: Re: Had a question for the Department of Optometry

External email to Cardiff University - Take care when replying/opening attachments or links.

Nid ebost mewnol o Brifysgol Caerdydd yw hwn - Cymerwch ofal wrth ateb/agor atodiadau neu ddolenni.

[Quoted text hidden]

Tom Piccolo <tompiccolo50@gmail.com>
To: OPTOMAdmissions <OPTOMAdmissions@cardiff.ac.uk>

3 March 2024 at 01:05

Hello

I have spoken to a Senior Business Manager at a different university looking after admissions for degree apprenticeships and have found out the following supposedly true information:

All university degrees be that Photography, Drama, Medicine or Engineering are at the same level of academic rigour and difficulty

Oxford and Cambridge set high requirements to maintain "their reputation" not to reflect the demand of the program

Anyone with any A Level grades could do any degree as all degrees are equivalent in difficulty

All BSc students studying any BSc course- be that BSc Nursing or BSc Optometry are on courses of the same difficulty so BSc Nursing equals BSc Optometry in difficulty

Despite BSc Nursing students having C grades at A Level and BSc Optometry students having A grades in the main at A Level- a BSc Nursing student could easily do the Optometry course as it is the same in difficulty

Setting entry requirements for different courses is irrelevant.
Apart from of course maintaining the high social prestige of top universities

What does this mean? That you are unfairly barring students from entering Optometry only to maintain the prestige of the Optometry profession as a whole.

It's got nothing to do with the academic course difficulty

Thanks

Tom

[Quoted text hidden]

Tom Piccolo <tompiccolo50@gmail.com>
To: OPTOMAdmissions <OPTOMAdmissions@cardiff.ac.uk>

4 March 2024 at 13:02

Hello

I was told by the manager for apprenticeships at my university the following:

What you are exploring is complex and full of nuance hence the desire to chat to you about it - ultimately it is the simple economics of supply and demand. If demand is high (~30 000 apply, ~9 000 places) and acceptance rates are low (~17%) in what is a competitive world, then there are over 20 000 people being rejected each year in the UK alone

They also told me that all BSc courses are exactly the same in difficulty regardless of institution or entry requirements, and entry requirements really only reflect demand- not the academic demand of the course.

But I was rejected from a course in Optometry at a different university on that basis- as my grades don't match the academic demands of the course and I am unsuitable for the course

I am just a bit confused and would appreciate it if you could perhaps clarify this for me due to your past experience in this field

Thanks

Tom

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